revolutionary movements, trade unions, multinational companies and the Roman Catholic Church among others. Thus, it would not be possible to understand British–Iranian relations during 1951–1953 or American–Cuban relations between 1959–1961 without taking into account the role of certain oil companies in both the cases.[31]

Holsti[32] identifies certain roles played by non-state actors. These roles imply that these non-state actors:

1. Introduce an issue into international diplomatic agenda.
2. Publicize and raise citizen consciousness regarding certain global or regional problems.
3. Lobby national governments and international organizations to make decisions favourable to their cause.
4. Seek outcome through direct action, sometimes (though relatively rare) involving the threat or use of force.

Therefore, it can be said with certainty that any organized unit that commands the identification of interests, and loyalty of individuals, which affects inter-state relations becomes a major competitor of states as actors. If the international processes are analyzed it can be seen without doubt that there may be tussle not only between the states but also between the states and non-state actors. Examples include the United Nations and Iraq, between OPEC and the industrialized West, between PLO and Israel, between an MNC and a state in the case of toxic gas accident at Union Carbide's plant resulting in the Bhopal Gas tragedy in India. Nevertheless, it can also be said that there may be several competitors to the power and authority of the states as actors, yet the states continue to enjoy predominance over any other international non-state actor.